CompAsia — Professional Deep Research Report

Southeast Asia's integrated device-lifecycle / recommerce platform. Compiled June 2026 from ~70 sources across five research tracks: company & funding, business model, performance, competitive landscape, and industry context. Where official IPO-disclosed figures and older marketing numbers conflict, the audited/IPO figures are treated as load-bearing.

1. Executive Snapshot

Field	Detail
Company	CompAsia (compasia.com / compasia.my)
Legal entities	CompAsia Sdn Bhd (Malaysia, inc. 2012) · CompAsia Pte Ltd (Singapore) · CompAsia Holdings Pte Ltd (SG, 2019, apparent parent)
Founded	2012 (some sources 2013); founder **Julius Lim** (Founder & CEO)
HQ	Petaling Jaya, Malaysia + Singapore base (100 Pasir Panjang Rd)
Positioning	"Southeast Asia's device circularity company" — largest integrated recommerce / device-lifecycle platform
Core markets	Malaysia, Singapore, Thailand, Philippines (+ wider 9–10 country distribution reach)
Funding	Series A led by **Gobi Partners** (Aug 2023, undisclosed); ~US$12.7M aggregate disclosed
Financials (MY)	Revenue ~RM180M (2025); pre-tax profit RM12M (2024) → RM20M (2025) → RM70M target (2026)
Scale	**3 million** cumulative device transactions (by Q3 2025); ~250–336 staff
Headline event	**Targeting Bursa Malaysia Main Market IPO in 1H 2027** — RM400–500M raise, ~RM2bn (~US$425M) valuation

The one-line thesis: CompAsia is a profitable, vertically-integrated, B2B2C device-lifecycle operator that quietly powers the trade-in programs of most major Malaysian/Singaporean telcos and OEMs — and is now heading for a Bursa Malaysia IPO.

2. Background & Founding Story

CompAsia's legal entity was incorporated in **Malaysia in 2012** (operations ramping from ~2013). Founder **Julius Lim** — an ex-**Boston Consulting Group** consultant with an Electrical Engineering/Economics degree from **Johns Hopkins** and an MBA from **Wharton** —

spotted the opportunity while at IT firm MCSB Systems: companies refresh hardware every 3–4 years and need to resell the old fleet.

He started CompAsia with ~**RM1 million** of his own and family capital, initially buying, refurbishing and reselling **PCs** online. When PCs proved slow, the company **pivoted into mobile phones (~2015)** — a far larger replacement-cycle market — with three friends investing as early backers. By 2016 it had become a one-stop trade-in/purchase platform, and from 2019 layered on apps, financing, and protection.

> **Flags:** Founding year appears as 2012 (registries) vs 2013 (some profiles) — reconcilable as incorporation vs operational launch. Julius Lim is consistently the sole/primary founder; the "three friends" were early investors, not co-founders.

Leadership

- **Julius Lim** — Founder & CEO (continuous; no leadership changes found 2023–2026)
- **George Hashim** — Chief Strategy Officer (joined 2018; 22+ yrs telecoms, ex-AmTrust Mobile Solutions Asia)
- **Henry Ng** — Head of regional buyback & trade-in division
- CFO / COO / CIO roles also listed (via org-chart aggregators — titles lower-confidence)

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3. Business Model & Strategy

CompAsia is **vertically integrated across the entire device lifecycle** — sourcing, data-wiping, grading, refurbishing, certifying, and reselling — monetised through several branded programs:

Stream	Brand / Program	What it is
Trade-in / buyback	**instaCash** (2019)	Instant valuation app, pickup, on-the-spot payment (MY, SG, TH, PH)
Device financing	**ReNew+**	Installment "pay-later" for devices, tenures up to 36 months
Device subscription	**ReNewNGo** (2024)	Upgrade/downgrade/return after 12 months; full ownership after 36 — the main current growth driver
Device protection	**instaCover**	"Asia's first digitalized device care program"; extended warranty + like-for-like swap
Certified pre-owned retail	**Shop CompAsia**	B2C e-store; up to 50% below retail; 1–12 month warranty
Wholesale / distribution	**CompAsia Wholesale**	Bulk pre-owned to global B2B buyers — a major SEA distributor
ITAD / data erasure	(enterprise)	DoD 5220.22-M secure wipe; MDM-unlock; recycle/resell

The circular-economy loop: Source → secure data-erase → diagnose/grade → refurbish/certify → resell/redistribute. Quality is marketed via a proprietary **"32-step quality check"** (guaranteeing 100% functionality and ≥80% battery health) plus a separate **3-tier cosmetic grading** (Excellent / Good / Fair).

The B2B2C moat — the key strategic insight

CompAsia's real differentiation is that it is the **invisible white-label engine** behind other brands' trade-in programs, not just a consumer refurbisher:

Partner	Program	CompAsia's role
Maxis (MY)	Maxis Trade-In	"Operated by CompAsia Sdn Bhd"
CelcomDigi (MY)	CelcomDigi Trade-In app	Built & operated by CompAsia
Yes / YTL (MY)	Trade-In Programme	"Collaborating partner"
Samsung Malaysia	Official trade-in	Valuations set & assessed via CompAsia App
vivo (MY)	X-series trade-in	CompAsia processor
Singtel / StarHub / M1 (SG)	Trade-in	CompAsia collection/processing partner
Senheng / senQ (MY)	SWAP / V-care trade-in	Runs on CompAsia's **SmartExchange app**

This makes CompAsia **B2B infrastructure to its own retail "competitors"** — a structural advantage. Its clearest head-to-head rival in this white-label role is **bolttech**, which powers U Mobile's trade-in and "Device Care."

Regional & channel reach beyond Malaysia: Globe Telecom and Beyond the Box (Apple Premium Reseller) in the Philippines; Singtel/StarHub/M1 in Singapore; a **Sime Motors (Sime Darby) e-waste partnership** (Mar 2025) across MY/TH/SG/ID. CompAsia also plugs into consumer credit at checkout — **0% installments via CIMB, Maybank, HSBC, RHB, AmBank, Standard Chartered, Public Bank, Hong Leong**, and **BNPL via Atome, Grab PayLater, and SPayLater**.

Physical retail build-out: from ~5–6 Malaysian stores to **~70 stores** (incl. Sabah & Sarawak), targeting **150 by end-2026** — a deliberate omnichannel push funded partly by the IPO.

> **Flags:** No confirmed exclusive OEM contract (it powers Apple/Samsung trade-ins but Apple's global processor is Likewize). No evidence of Shopee/Lazada storefronts — CompAsia positions against the marketplace model. The "~50+ partners across Asia" figure is company-stated.

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4. Performance & Financials

IPO-disclosed (Malaysia operations — highest confidence)

Metric	FY2024	FY2025	FY2026 (target)
Revenue (MY)	—	**~RM180M**	**~RM400M**
Pre-tax profit	**RM12M**	**RM20M**	**RM70M**
ReNewNGo subscribers	—	~20,000	50,000 (end-26 target)

Scale trajectory

- Devices: <5,000 units (2015) → 500,000 (2018) → 600,000+ (2021) → **2.1M cumulative (2019–2022) → 3M cumulative transactions (Q3 2025)**
- > 100,000 trade-ins facilitated in 2025
- Retail: ~70 stores in Malaysia (2026), targeting 150 by end-2026
- Employees: ~250 (2022) → ~336 (2026, aggregator)

> **Critical caveat — do not draw a false trend line.** Older "revenue" numbers (RM300M in 2019; **>RM1bn / US$237M projected for 2022**) are **gross recommerce/transaction value at group/regional scope**, not statutory revenue. The RM180M (2025) is **Malaysia-only audited-style revenue**. They measure different things — never juxtapose them as a decline. Third-party aggregator revenue estimates (US$65M, US$250–500M) are unreliable and conflict 4×.

Bottom line: CompAsia is **profitable and growing** (pre-tax profit RM12M → RM20M, targeting RM70M), which is rare in a sector where even the global leader (Back Market) only reached profitability in 2026.

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5. Funding, Investors & IPO

Event	Date	Detail
Series A	Aug 2023	Led by **Gobi Partners** (incl. Gobi Dana Impak, Khazanah-linked); + **InnoVen Capital**, **OSK-SBI Venture Partners**. Amount undisclosed.
Strategic investment	Aug 2018	Took a stake in **InstaCash** (India recommerce) to enter India
Pre-IPO round	2026 (in progress)	Raising from HNW investors at a discount to IPO price

Event	Date	Detail
IPO	**Targeted 1H 2027**	**Bursa Malaysia Main Market**; raise **RM400–500M (~US$101–126M)**; **~RM2bn (~US$425M) valuation**

- **Total disclosed funding:** ~US$12.7M (aggregator estimate; both Series A rounds were undisclosed, so true figure may differ — some press cited ~US$25M).
- **Use of IPO proceeds:** working capital, scaling **ReNewNGo**, and strengthening omnichannel/physical retail in Malaysia.

> **Flags:** Susquehanna/SIG, ADB, and Indelible Ventures are **not** confirmed CompAsia investors despite appearing in some briefs. The "Jan 2025 Series A" in databases is likely a later tranche of the 2023 round.

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6. Competitive Landscape

CompAsia sits in a **B2B2C, owner-operator** position — distinct from pure marketplaces. Competitors fall into tiers:

Tier 1 — Direct competitors (refurbished + lifecycle)

Competitor	Origin	Model	vs CompAsia
Cashify	India	Buyback + refurbished + lifecycle	**Most acute regional threat** — entered SEA in FY24; comparable scale, profitable
Servify	India/ global	Asset-light B2B lifecycle/protection programs	Direct B2B overlap at global scale; IPO-bound — a likely valuation comp
Recommerce Group	France	B2B program operator + own refurb	The **structural twin** in Europe (€175M rev 2024) — a maturity benchmark
Reebelo	Singapore	B2C marketplace + care	SEA-origin but marketplace/US-pivoted, asset-light; CompAsia is financially stronger
Back Market	Global	Pure refurbished marketplace	Category leader (~US$5.5B val); the global benchmark, not a SEA operator

Tier 2 — Enablers / infrastructure

Phonecheck (diagnostics/certification SaaS), **bolttech** (the direct white-label rival — powers U Mobile), Likewize (Apple's global trade-in processor).

Tier 3 — SEA marketplaces (supply-side overlap only)

Carousell / Mudah.my (C2C listings — compete for supply of used devices, no refurbishment), **Machines / Switch** (Apple Premium Resellers — sell-out side only).

Flag: The "Reebelo collapse" premise is **not corroborated** — Reebelo was still operating and raising capital through mid-2025 (though a May 2025 convertible note hints at strain). Servify and Back Market both took valuation haircuts vs 2022 peaks, reflecting broad recommerce repricing.

7. Industry Context & Market Drivers

- **APAC is the largest and fastest-growing refurbished-device region** (~41% of global revenue share, 2025), with used devices **outpacing new** (used ~3.2% YoY growth vs ~1% for new — IDC).
- **SEA secondhand smartphone sales grew ~5% YoY (H1 2025)** (Counterpoint); emerging-market refurbished ASP is rising toward new-phone ASP.
- **Structural tailwinds:** rising new-phone prices widen the value gap; upgrade cycles stretching to 3–4 years expands the used pool; sustainability preference; **Malaysia's incoming mandatory EPR** (Extended Producer Responsibility) over 3–5 years forces OEMs toward accredited take-back partners — directly favouring formal players like CompAsia.

Global market-size estimates vary 3–4× across consultancies (US$33B–67B in 2024–25) — treat as directional ranges, cite Counterpoint/IDC for credibility. A clean **SEA-only refurbished TAM is a genuine data gap**.

8. SWOT Analysis

Strengths - Profitable & growing (rare in recommerce); IPO-ready financials - Deep B2B2C moat — embedded white-label engine for telcos/OEMs/retailers - Vertical integration captures margin across the full lifecycle - Strong ESG/circularity narrative aligned with incoming EPR regulation

Weaknesses - Thin, supply-constrained margins inherent to refurbished devices - Heavy reliance on partner channels (telcos/OEMs can switch to bolttech) - Revenue disclosure opacity (group vs Malaysia-only scoping) - Modest disclosed external capital (~US$12.7M) for a regional operator

Opportunities - ReNewNGo subscription scaling (20k → 100k target by 2027) - Indonesia/Philippines/Thailand expansion - Mandatory EPR creating accredited-partner demand - IPO capital to build omnichannel retail

Threats - Cashify's regional encroachment; bolttech in white-label trade-in - ASP erosion & device-supply scarcity (the binding constraint) - Grey-market parts, counterfeit devices, consumer-trust deficits - Recommerce sector valuation repricing (Servify, Back Market haircuts)

9. Key Takeaways

1. **CompAsia is the infrastructure layer of SEA device recommerce**, not just a used-phone seller — it runs the trade-in programs its retail rivals depend on. Lead any analysis with this.
2. **It is genuinely profitable and IPO-bound** (Bursa Main Market, 1H 2027, ~RM2bn target) — unusual in a category littered with cash-burning marketplaces.
3. **ReNewNGo (device subscription) is the strategic bet** driving the FY2026 revenue jump to ~RM400M.
4. **Watch the binding constraints:** device supply, partner concentration (bolttech risk), and margin pressure — these define the downside.
5. **Regulatory tailwind:** Malaysia's mandatory EPR rollout structurally favours formal, accredited lifecycle operators.

Caveats

- Direct page-fetching was blocked (HTTP 403) across all sources, so findings rest on search-result extraction cross-referenced across multiple independent sources per claim — reliable for claims, exact verbatim figures not captured.
- The biggest analytical trap is the **revenue-scope conflict** (group recommerce GMV vs Malaysia statutory revenue) — handled explicitly in §4.
- Funding total, country count (4 core vs 9–10), and some leadership titles vary across sources and are flagged inline.
- ESG impact metrics (420 t e-waste avoided, 181 kt CO_2, 46B gallons water) are company-reported and unaudited.

Selected Sources

- **IPO & financials:** The Star (17–18 Mar 2026), New Straits Times, The Edge Malaysia, Bernama, TNGlobal (Mar 2026)
- **Funding:** Gobi Partners, Digital News Asia, e27, DealStreetAsia, kr-asia, Crunchbase, Tracxn
- **Business model & partners:** CelcomDigi / Maxis / Yes / Singtel / Samsung MY trade-in T&Cs; senQ / Senheng; thesun.my; Lowyat; compasia.com
- **Competitors:** TechCrunch & Sacra (Back Market), Cathay Innovation & PRNewswire (Reebelo), Tracxn (Servify, Cashify), Recommerce Group, bolttech press
- **Industry:** Counterpoint Research, IDC, Mordor Intelligence; Eco-Business / MIDA / Malay Mail (Malaysia EPR & e-waste)

Compiled via a multi-track parallel web-research workflow, June 2026.